Lab 04 — Create Episode 1 with Claude and Higgsfield

Course: Agentic AI for Video Creation (C436)

Day 1 · Topic 2 · about 75 minutes · slides 104–110

Agent: Claude Desktop + Higgsfield MCP — the video-script and higgsfield-video skills

Features: Shot list · asset descriptions · scene and cinematic prompts · approval · credit plan · reference stills · low-res drafts · upgrade the keepers · jobs_wait · Higgsfield folder · download · lahlah-edit.json

The story so far

The storyboard is approved and Priya has set a credit budget. Your job today: get every shot of Episode 1 made in Higgsfield, with Rachel, Ah Ma and the tin the same in every shot, filed in one Higgsfield folder, and downloaded ready to edit — without spending full-resolution credits on shots you will throw away.

Your goal

Direct Claude to produce the episode in Higgsfield — script, prompts, approval, budget, references, low-res drafts, then high-res finals — and keep every asset traceable in one Higgsfield folder.

You'll produce

Higgsfield folder "Kopi & Coins – Ep1 micro-drama (TikTok)" with reference stills, drafts and finals; clips saved as S01-SH01.mp4 …; lahlah-edit.json and captions.srt

What is in this folder

- `assets/scene-prompts-ep01.pdf`
- `assets/cinematic-effects-cheatsheet.pdf`
- `assets/credit-plan-template.csv`
- `assets/sample/lahlah-edit.json`
- `assets/sample/captions.srt`
- `assets/sample/status-table.pdf`
- `prompts.html` — open in a browser; one click copies each prompt into Claude
- `prompts.pdf` — the same prompts, printable
- `evidence/checklist.pdf` — what to capture as proof
- `../prompt-builder.html` — build your own prompt for any stage, genre and platform

Why each step matters

- The video-script skill turns each storyboard card into a shot that a model can make: one action, the asset's five traits, one camera move, the lighting and grade, and the aspect ratio. It writes an image-to-video prompt (animate from a reference still) and a text-to-video fallback.
- Cinematic effects are Higgsfield's named camera presets — Dolly In, Crash Zoom In, Whip Pan, 360 Orbit, Crane Up, FPV Drone, Bullet Time and 57 more. Claude matches each shot to a preset from presets_show; where no preset fits, it writes the move into the prompt in plain words.
- Draft low, finish high. Higgsfield prices by model, length and resolution: an 8-second Kling 3.0 shot at 720p costs about 16 credits; an 8-second Seedance 2.5 shot at 1080p about 72. Test framing, action and continuity on cheap low-res drafts, then spend high-res credits only on the shots you keep.
- References first is the consistency rule: approve one still per character and prop, then animate every shot from that still. A face that never has to be re-invented cannot drift.
- Higgsfield files MCP generations in Assets. Make a folder with the project's name and Move every job into it — the skill lists the job IDs. Claude cannot fetch the MP4s itself; you click each result link and save the clip.

Step by step

1. **Script the shots** — Prompt A calls the video-script skill: shots, VO, asset descriptions and two video prompts per shot, as an artifact.
2. **Add cinematic effects, approve** — Prompt Builder (Stage Scene creation): tick camera presets, angles, lens, lighting, grade; paste as changes; reply APPROVED.
3. **Agree the budget** — Prompt B calls the higgsfield-video skill: balance, models_explore, a credit table at draft and final resolution.
4. **References first** — Claude calls generate_image for Rachel, Ah Ma and the tin. Pick one still each.
5. **Draft every shot low-res** — Cheap model, 480p or 720p, generate_video_batch then jobs_wait. Fix the story here, where a re-roll is cheap.
6. **Upgrade the keepers** — Prompt C re-makes only the approved drafts at 1080p on the final model, from the same still and prompt.
7. **File, download, hand off** — Move every job into the Higgsfield folder; save each clip as S01-SH01.mp4 in 05-edit; download lahlah-edit.json and captions.srt.

The prompts

PROMPT A — shots, assets and video prompts (video-script skill)

> Use the video-script skill on the approved storyboard.
>
> For every shot give: shot ID, timeline seconds, the one action,
> dialogue or VO, on-screen text (added in the editor, never
> generated), the assets in shot with their five fixed traits,
> and two prompts:
> - i2v: animate from the approved reference still;
> - t2v: fallback with no still.
>
> Scene prompt formula:
> [SHOT_SIZE] [ANGLE] of [SUBJECT], [ACTION], in
> [LOCATION_TIME], [LIGHTING], [MOOD], [COLOUR_GRADE],

> camera: [CAMERA_MOVE], [LENS], 9:16, no on-screen text,
> no logos.
>
> Show it as an HTML artifact marked DRAFT and stop.

PROMPT B — budget, references, low-res drafts (higgsfield-video skill)

> Use the higgsfield-video skill to produce Episode 1.
>
> 1. Check the storyboard and script are APPROVED.
> 2. Call balance and models_explore: a cheap draft model
> (480p or 720p) and a final model (1080p).
> 3. Credit table: stills, low-res drafts, 1080p upgrades,
> +30%. Budget [BUDGET] credits. Ask before every batch.
> 4. On Go: generate_image for Rachel, Ah Ma and the tin;
> wait for my picks.
> 5. Draft every shot LOW-RES with generate_video_batch;
> poll jobs_wait; keep the status table. No 1080p yet.
> 6. Folder: "Kopi & Coins – Ep1 micro-drama (TikTok)".
> List the job IDs to Move into it.

PROMPT C — upgrade the keepers to high resolution

> These drafts are approved: [SHOT_IDS]. Re-generate ONLY these at
> 1080p on the final model, from the same reference still, the
> same prompt and the same camera preset. Show the cost first.
> Leave rejected drafts alone. Add the new job IDs to the status
> table and the folder list.

PROMPT D — re-roll one draft, then hand off

> S03-SH01 drifted: the tin has no dent and the labels are
> garbled. Re-roll this LOW-RES draft only, from the approved tin
> still, camera Static, no text in the prompt — we add the
> labels in LahLah Video.
>
> When every shot is final, write lahlah-edit.json (schema
> lahlah-edit/1, platform tiktok, 9:16, 30 fps, clips in timeline
> order with trim_in and trim_out, transitions from the
> storyboard, captions in timeline seconds) and captions.srt.
> Give me the 1080p download links in order, named S01-SH01.mp4
> and so on, and the total credits spent.

Check your work

- □ The script artifact is APPROVED, with an i2v and a t2v prompt and one camera move for every shot.
- □ A credit table at draft and final resolution was approved before any generation.
- □ One approved reference still each for Rachel, Ah Ma and the tin.
- □ Every shot was drafted low-res first; only approved drafts were upgraded to 1080p.

- □ Every still, draft and final sits in the Higgsfield folder named after the project, with its job ID in the status table.
- □ The 1080p clips are saved in 05-edit as S01-SH01.mp4 …, with lahlah-edit.json and captions.srt beside them.

If it goes wrong

- **Credits run out mid-batch** — Stop. Keep the low-res drafts and use the mock clips from Lab 5 for missing shots; upgrade later.
- **A job returns ip_detected** — Confirm you hold the rights (fictional characters only) before Claude calls reveal_generation.
- **Rachel's glasses disappear** — Re-roll the draft from the approved still, repeat the five traits, keep the shot under 6 seconds.
- **Claude cannot download the MP4** — Expected. Click each result link and Save video as…, or download from Higgsfield Assets.

Stretch

- Ask Claude to draft one hero shot twice at low res — one with Dolly In, one with Crash Zoom In — and upgrade only the one that lands the hook.

> **Draft low, finish high. A re-roll at 480p costs a fraction of one at 1080p — make your mistakes where they are cheap.**

Next

Lab 05 — Edit, Review and Refine in LahLah Video. Keep what you produced — the next lab starts from it.

Safety

Use only this lab's fictitious characters and data and your own accounts. Never paste an API key, password or personal data into a prompt, a file you share or a screenshot. Nothing is uploaded publicly; upload plans stay private until a person approves.